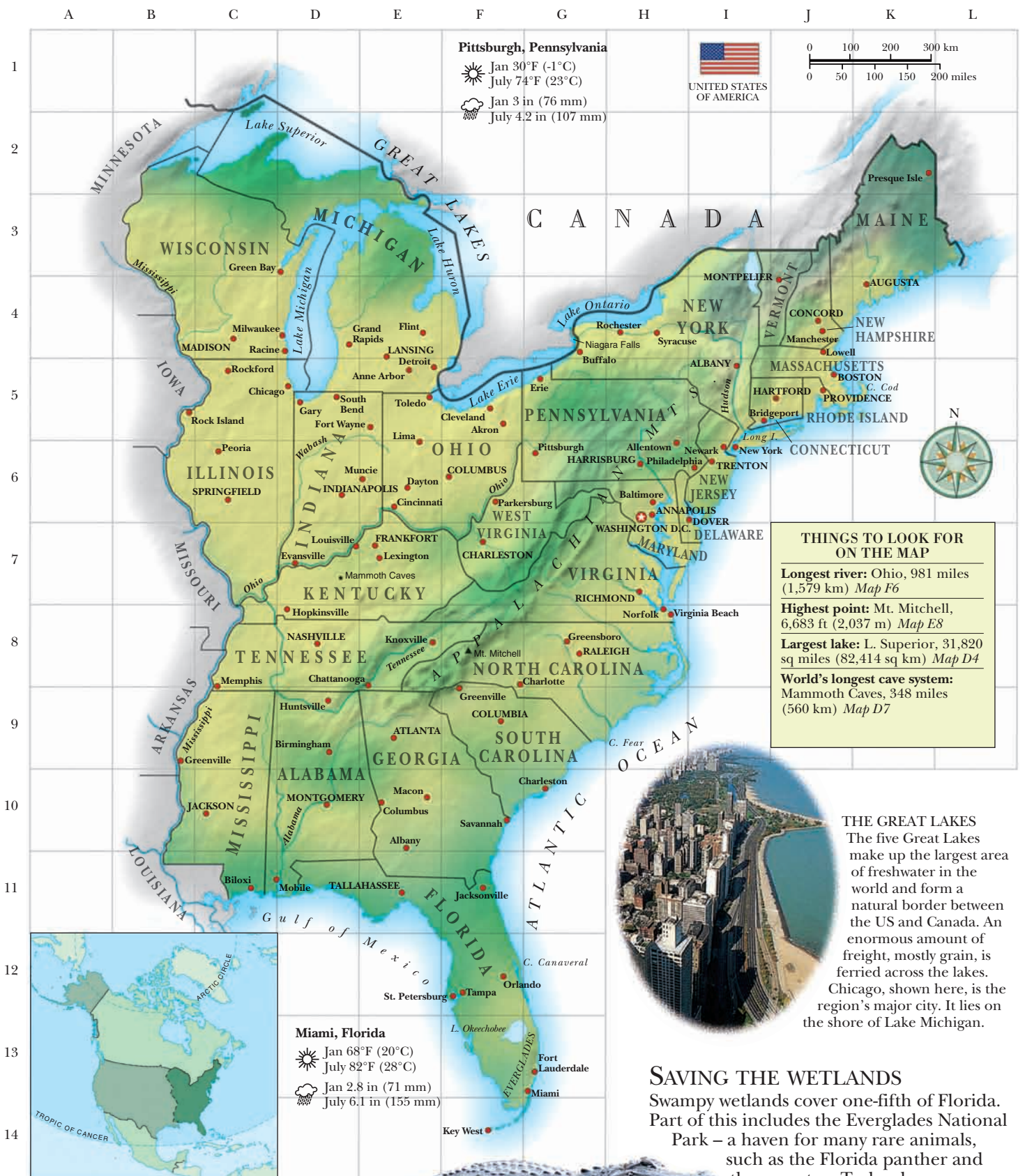




THE GREAT LAKES
 The five Great Lakes make up the largest area of freshwater in the world and form a natural border between the US and Canada. An enormous amount of freight, mostly grain, is ferried across the lakes. Chicago, shown here, is the region's major city. It lies on the shore of Lake Michigan.

SAVING THE WETLANDS

Swampy wetlands cover one-fifth of Florida. Part of this includes the Everglades National Park – a haven for many rare animals, such as the Florida panther and the manatee. Today, large areas of the Everglades are threatened by drainage programs aimed at creating more land for building and farming. A state plan was launched in 1994 to save the remaining wetlands and create new areas of swamp.

The American alligator lives in the swamps and rivers of Florida, Georgia, and Alabama. It can grow up to 12 ft (3.6 m) long.

